

FILE : T11_Cohort_AI_Automation_2026-10-01_1649.md
CREATED : 2026-10-01_1649 UTC
PURPOSE : Teacher lesson plan for "AI Automation for Small Business Owners: 4-Week Live Cohort".
READ FIRST: 00_IEBC_Teaching_Playbook_2026-10-01_1649.md
PDF GENERATED : 2026-10-01_1702 UTC

T11 Teacher Guide: AI Automation for Small Business Owners (4-Week Live Cohort)

Format	4 weekly live sessions, 90 minutes each, on Zoom, recorded
Group size	Up to 20 (Producer required above 12)
Level	Beginner
Demo business	Lakeside Home Services
Student deliverable	Four working automations + a 90-day automation plan
Between sessions	One assignment per week (about 1–2 hours) + optional 30-min office hours

This is IEBC's flagship live class. It uses the same skills as T02, but taught live with accountability. Teachers should have taught or completed T02 first.

Cohort-level objectives

By demo day, every student has four automations running in their business (lead follow-up, scheduling/reminders, invoice reminders, content or reporting), knows how to maintain them, and has a written plan for the next 90 days.

Before week 1

- ☐ Send the pre-class email (Playbook §13.3). Ask students to bring: their top 3 annoying tasks, logins to their email/calendar, and free accounts on the assistant and automation tool you'll use.
- ☐ Read every student's enrollment goal (hub → Academy page). Group breakout rooms by business type where possible.
- ☐ Set up the class space (shared folder or community) with the worksheets.

Week 1: Time audit and AI basics

Session objective: Every student has a scored time audit and a working prompt library of 3 prompts.

Time	Segment	Details
0:00–0:10	Welcome	★ Introductions in chat (name, business, most annoying task). ★ Recording notice, data rule, how the 4 weeks work, demo-day goal.
0:10–0:25	SHOW: the time audit	★ Score method (frequency × time × frustration). Score Lakeside's tasks live. ★ Good first targets: repetitive, rule-based, low-risk.
0:25–0:40	BUILD: own time audit	Students fill in the worksheet. Teacher and Producer check in with anyone who hasn't typed anything in 5 minutes.
0:40–0:45	Break	
0:45–1:00	SHOW + TRY: prompting workshop	★ 4-part prompt. Weak vs. strong prompt side by side. ★ Mistake moment (AI invents a policy). Students run the demo prompt.
1:00–1:15	BUILD: 3 prompts for their top tasks	Breakout rooms of 4–5. Each person shares one prompt; the room suggests one improvement.
1:15–1:25	SHARE	3 students share before/after prompts.
1:25–1:30	Close	Assignment, office-hours time, survey.

Assignment (week 1): Finish the time audit (with "before" hours for the top 3) and save 5 prompts in a prompt library. Use one prompt on a real task and note the time saved.

Watch for: Students who say they "have nothing to automate." Ask them to walk you through yesterday hour by hour; the targets show up.

Stretch: Add "ask me 3 questions first" to every prompt.

Week 2: Leads and follow-up

Session objective: Every student builds and tests a lead capture → follow-up automation.

Time	Segment	Details
0:00–0:10	Welcome + wins	2 students share a prompt that saved time this week.
0:10–0:25	SHOW	★ Trigger → action → check. Build Lakeside: form → spreadsheet → instant acknowledgment → task with AI-drafted reply → 2-day follow-up → ★ stop rule when they reply.
0:25–0:40	TRY	Students build the same flow with demo data, step by step. Wait for thumbs-up after each step.
0:40–0:45	Break	

Time	Segment	Details
0:45-1:15	BUILD	Students connect it to their real form/inbox. ★ 3 test runs with fake data before turning on. Producer runs a "stuck" breakout room.
1:15-1:25	SHARE	2-3 students screen-share their run history.
1:25-1:30	Close	Assignment, survey.

Assignment (week 2): Lead follow-up live in their business; screenshot of the flow + 3 successful test runs.

Watch for: No stop rule; AI replies sent without review; connecting personal email accounts instead of business ones.

Stretch: Different reply for after-hours inquiries; SMS acknowledgment.

Week 3: Scheduling, invoices and payments

Session objective: Every student has appointment reminders and invoice reminders running.

Time	Segment	Details
0:00-0:10	Welcome + wins	2 students: first real lead handled by the automation.
0:10-0:25	SHOW	★ Booking link with buffers; 24-hour reminder with reschedule link; no-show message. ★ Invoice reminders at 3/10/21 days; ★ AI never changes amounts or due dates.
0:25-0:40	TRY	Demo booking page + demo invoice reminder.
0:40-0:45	Break	
0:45-1:15	BUILD	Students set up whichever of the two matters more first, then the other. Use built-in features of their booking/invoicing tools before custom automations.
1:15-1:25	SHARE	
1:25-1:30	Close	Assignment; ★ remind them demo day is next week, and explain the format.

Assignment (week 3): Both automations live; prepare a 3-minute demo-day share.

Week 4: Content, reporting and demo day

Session objective: Students add a fourth automation, show their work and leave with a 90-day plan.

Time	Segment	Details
0:00–0:05	Welcome	
0:05–0:20	SHOW	◆ A month of social posts in one session (T06 method, condensed). ★ A weekly numbers report: leads, bookings, invoices overdue, sent automatically every Monday.
0:20–0:40	BUILD	Students pick content OR weekly report as automation #4.
0:40–0:45	Break	
0:45–1:15	DEMO DAY	Each student: 2–3 minutes. <i>What I automated, before vs. after, what's next.</i> Class reacts in chat. (Over 10 students: two breakout rooms with teacher and Producer each running one.)
1:15–1:25	90-day plan	★ Weekly 10-minute check routine; ★ next 3 targets from the time audit; ★ when to add a human review step.
1:25–1:30	Close	Certificate, survey, ★ one mention of course credit and a free call for anyone who wants IEBC to build more.

Final assignment: 90-day plan + before/after hours for all automations.

Rubric (whole cohort)

	Not yet	Meets	Strong
Automations	Fewer than 3 working	4 working, each tested	4+ working with run history and a weekly check
Measurement	No numbers	Before/after hours for each	Also a monthly tracking sheet
Plan	None	Next 3 targets listed	Dated plan with review step

Office hours (optional, 30 min weekly)

First come, first served screen-share fixes. Producer keeps a queue. Note recurring problems for the next session's opening and for Guide Change Requests.

If a student falls behind

Message them after the session. Offer office hours and the recording. A student who is one automation behind at week 3 can still finish; at demo day they show what they have plus their plan.